

Metaphysical painting

Reacting against Cubism and Futurism, Metaphysical painting was founded in Italy in 1917 by Giorgio de Chirico (1888–1978), his brother, Alberto Savinio (1891–1952) and ex-Futurist Carlo Carrà (1881–1966). De Chirico began the style c.1911, painting illogical, dreamlike images with sharp contrasts of light and shadow, often with a vaguely threatening, mysterious quality, and usually using dramatic one-point perspective. His ideas arose from his reading of the German philosophers Nietzsche, Schopenhauer and Weininger. The group was later joined by Giorgio Morandi (1890–1964).

Poet Guillaume Apollinaire gave the movement its name when he called de Chirico's painting 'metaphysical', from the Greek for 'beyond real things'. Carrà met de Chirico for the first time in February 1917, and that year, he and de Chirico worked closely together for some months, but in 1919, Carrà published a book, *Pittura Metafisica*, that minimized de Chirico's importance and created great animosity between them.



Chirico, *The Song of Love*, 1914